



FOCUS ON... HELIUM

Helium has a very low boiling point so its liquid form is used to keep high-tech devices cold.



▲ Weather balloons filled with helium are sent high into the atmosphere to collect data.



▲ Liquid helium is used to maintain the low temperatures required by the superconducting magnets that make a maglev train (shown here in Shanghai, China) float above the tracks.

Helium

2
He

This noble gas is much more common in space than on Earth. It is produced from the radioactive decay of uranium and thorium deep underground. Helium collects in reservoirs of natural gas, from where it is extracted.

ATOMIC MASS 4.003

STATE Gas

DISCOVERY 1895 (Per Teodor Cleve, Nils Abraham Langlet, and Sir William Ramsay)

Helium makes up about 10 per cent of Jupiter's atmosphere

Jupiter, the largest planet in the Solar System

